

Questions to answer when your planning involves a corporation.



For incorporated professionals, business owners, and families with complexity, planning is not just about retirement. It is about coordinating personal cash flow, corporate assets, tax, estate decisions, and family goals.

Bracket Planning

Independent, fee-only, advice-only financial planning | Alberta | St. John's

CORPORATE PLANNING

TAX EFFICIENCY

ESTATE PLANNING

FOR CLIENTS WITH COMPLEXITY

- Professional corporation or holding company
- Retained earnings or corporate investments
- Business succession, sale, or wind-down decisions
- Estate, equalization, or intergenerational planning needs

WHAT THIS HANDOUT COVERS

Use these questions to start organizing the decisions that connect your corporation, personal cash flow, retirement income, tax exposure, and family wealth transfer.

Start with the corporate and personal cash-flow decisions.

These questions help clarify how your corporation, retained earnings, retirement income, and tax picture fit together.

01

How should I pay myself from my corporation?

- Should I use salary, dividends, or a blended approach?
- How much personal cash flow do I actually need?
- How does compensation affect CPP, RRSP room, and corporate cash?
- What should stay inside the corporation?

02

What should happen to retained earnings?

- Should corporate investments be preserved, drawn down, or moved personally?
- How will retained earnings support retirement income?
- Could passive income or future withdrawals create tax issues?

03

Can corporate and personal assets support retirement?

- Which assets should be used first?
- How do RRSP/RRIF, TFSA, non-registered, and corporate assets work together?
- When should CPP and OAS fit into the plan?

04

How will taxes affect income and estate value?

- What will my taxable income look like year by year?
- Can withdrawal sequencing reduce lifetime tax?
- Could corporate assets create estate or liquidity issues later?

05

Is succession or wind-down part of the plan?

- Will the business be sold, transferred, wound down, or continued?
- What does the transition mean for income and tax?

Coordinate the plan, then keep it current.

The last questions connect corporate decisions to estate planning, annual reviews, and an independent second opinion.

o6

How should investments be located?

- Which assets belong personally, corporately, or in registered accounts?
- Is the portfolio built for tax efficiency and future withdrawals?
- What happens during inflation, higher rates, or market volatility?

o7

Is my estate plan coordinated?

- Will my assets pass the way I intend?
- Will my children be treated fairly?
- How do corporate assets, insurance, and liquidity affect the estate?

o8

What should be reviewed every year?

- Compensation, corporate cash, investment returns, tax rules, health, family circumstances, estate goals, real estate, inheritances, and business changes.

— WHAT A PLAN SHOULD GIVE YOU

- How to pay yourself from the corporation
- How much you can spend personally
- Which accounts and entities to use and when
- How retained earnings fit into retirement income
- How tax and estate decisions connect over time

— INDEPENDENT SECOND OPINION

Bracket Planning provides independent, fee-only, advice-only financial planning. We do not sell investment products and do not charge based on assets under management.

The goal is simple: a clear financial roadmap across your personal, corporate, tax, and estate decisions.